

Indian History Overview

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Following this, the Vedic period (1500–500 BCE) laid the foundations of Hindu culture, scriptures, and social structures.

The Mahajanapadas emerged as powerful kingdoms, eventually leading to the rise of large empires.

The Maurya Empire (322–185 BCE), founded by Chandragupta Maurya, became one of the largest empires in ancient India.

Under Emperor Ashoka, it reached its peak, spreading Buddhism across Asia.

The Gupta Empire (320–550 CE) is often called the Golden Age of India due to major achievements in science, mathematics, astronomy, literature, and art.

Throughout medieval India, several powerful dynasties and sultanates emerged, including the Cholas, Rajputs, Delhi Sultanate, and the Mughal Empire.

Mughal rulers like Akbar, Jahangir, and Shah Jahan contributed significantly to art, architecture, and administration.

The Taj Mahal, built by Shah Jahan, remains one of the world's most iconic monuments.

The arrival of European powers in the 16th century, especially the British, dramatically reshaped India's political and economic landscape.

The British East India Company gradually gained control, leading to the establishment of British rule after the Revolt of 1857.

The Indian freedom struggle, led by figures like Mahatma Gandhi, Jawaharlal Nehru, Subhas Chandra Bose, and many others, eventually resulted in India gaining independence on 15 August 1947.

Post-independence, India adopted a democratic system and has since grown into one of the world's largest economies, with rapid development in technology, space research, and industry.

This document provides a brief overview of the major phases that shaped Indian history.

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